



Unit 3 · Outcome 1 · Maintaining Biodiversity

Treaties & legal frameworks

KK13

VCE Environmental Science · Units 3 & 4 · Exam study summary

Key knowledge. 13 Treaties & legal frameworks International National State Local No single law protects a threatened species

Digital Vector EnviroSci · single-topic mastery summary with worked good-vs-bad answers, exam traps, command words and practice.



Treaties & legal frameworks

Unit 3 · Outcome 1 · Key Knowledge 13 Treaties & legal frameworks International National State Local No single law protects a threatened species. Instead, protection is built in layers — a global treaty on top of a national act on top of a state act on top of a covenant on one family's paddock. This dot point is about knowing which instrument operates at which scale, what each one actually does, and which ones carry the force of law. The VCAA dot point names six instruments you must be able to describe: CITES , the IUCN Red List , classified World Heritage

Protection is a ladder, not a single rung

The big idea Protection is a ladder, not a single rung Examiners love the words international, national and local because they test whether you can place an instrument at the right scale. Read this ladder top-to-bottom: as you descend, the geography shrinks (whole planet → one nation → one state → one paddock) but the enforcement bites harder and closer to the ground . Scale 01 International The whole planet CITES — a treaty that regulates cross-border trade in endangered species and their parts. IUCN Red List — the global assessment of every species' ex

Instrument inspector

Interactive · Scene 2 Instrument inspector Click a glowing tier in the stack to bring it forward. Each instrument is colour-coded by scale, and the panel tells you its scope, whether it carries the force of law , and what it actually does for our Helmeted Honeyeater. click a tier Tap a platform to inspect that instrument. SELECT AN INSTRUMENT The six instruments Each of the six protections sits at a different scale. Select one from the stack to read what it does, whether it is legally binding, and how it touches the honeyeater. ↑ Use the 3D stack or the

The six instruments, in plain terms

The detail The six instruments, in plain terms CITES · international treaty The Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species. It controls the cross-border trade of listed species and their products (ivory, skins, live animals, timber). Species sit in Appendix I (threatened with extinction — commercial trade banned), Appendix II (trade allowed under permit) or Appendix III (a country asks others for help). It governs trade — not habitat, not local management. IUCN Red List · global assessment The world's most authoritative inventory of conserva

From treaty to paddock: does it bind?

Interactive · Scene 3 From treaty to paddock: does it bind? Press Trace the chain to watch a single threat — illegal export of a rare orchid — travel down the scales of protection. The animation shows the key exam idea: an international treaty is only guidance until a domestic law makes it binding . animation A treaty overseas → enacted by the EPBC Act → applied by Victoria → enforced on the ground. ► Trace the chain Idle — the orchid is unprotected until the chain runs.

Sort each clue to its scale

◇ ACTIVE RECALL

Check yourself Sort each clue to its scale Drag each instrument or description into the scale where it operates. Then press Check . This is exactly the placement skill multiple-choice and short-answer questions test. International National State Local / private s

Two analogies for the exam

Make it stick Two analogies for the exam Russian nesting dolls Picture matryoshka dolls. The biggest, outermost doll is the international layer (CITES, IUCN, World Heritage). Inside it sits the national doll (EPBC), then the state doll (FFG), then the tiny innermost doll — the covenant on one paddock. Each smaller doll fits inside the larger one, just as state law operates inside the frame set by national and international rules. Open the big doll and you still need the small ones to actually hold the bird. Building a house The IUCN Red List is the

Command-word decoder

◆ COMMAND WORDS

Decode the question Command-word decoder The command word tells you the shape of the answer. Misread it and you lose marks even with correct facts. Identify / Name 1 mark State the instrument with no explanation. "Name one international instrument that protects threatened species." → CITES. One word can be the full mark. Describe 2–3 marks Say what the instrument is and what it does . For EPBC: it is Australia's national environmental law that lists threatened species and requires significant impacts to be assessed. Distinguish / Compare 2–4 marks Give a

Exam traps that cost real marks

⚠ EXAM TRAPS

Avoid these Exam traps that cost real marks Trap 01 "The IUCN Red List is a law." It is an assessment of extinction risk with no enforcement power . It informs laws but does not compel anyone. Fix: call it a status assessment / inventory, not legislation. Trap 02 "CITES protects habitat." CITES only regulates international trade . It does nothing about land clearing, pollution or local management. Fix: tie CITES strictly to cross-border trade in species and parts. Trap 03 Mixing up EPBC and FFG jurisdictions. EPBC is Commonwealth (national) ; FFG is Vict

The P·E·L writing trainer

📝 P·E·L WRITING

Write like a state-ranker The P·E·L writing trainer For "explain" and "evaluate" answers, build each idea as Point · Explain · Link . It forces you past naming an instrument into showing its mechanism and tying it back to the species. POINT State the instrument + scale "At the national scale, the EPBC Act 1999 protects the Helmeted Honeyeater." EXPLAIN Say what it does "As a listed threatened species it is a Matter of National Environmental Significance, so any action with a significant impact must be referred and assessed." LINK Tie it to the outcome "T



The P·E·L answer structure — make a Point, support with Evidence, then Link to the question.

Five VCAA-style questions

★ PRACTICE & SELF-MARK

Exam practice · Five VCAA-style questions Attempt each in your logbook first, then reveal the marking guide and model answer. Award yourself marks honestly — the dock bottom-right tracks your total out of 20 . Q1 Name two international instruments and one Victorian instrument that protect threatened species. 2 marks Reveal marking guide ▼ Model answer International: CITES and the IUCN Red List (or classified World Heritage areas). Victorian: the Flora and Fauna Guarantee Act 1988 . Marking guide 1 mark — two correct international instruments 1 mark — the

The KK13 cheat sheet

✦ RECAP / CHEAT SHEET

One-screen recap The KK13 cheat sheet CITES International treaty · regulates cross-border trade in endangered species & parts · Appendices I–III IUCN Red List Global assessment of extinction risk · not a law · supplies the categories laws adopt World Heritage International listing of sites of outstanding universal value · protected in Australia via the EPBC Act EPBC Act 1999 National law (Cth) · lists threatened species · protects MNES · assesses significant impacts · enacts treaties FFG Act 1988 State law (Vic) · Threatened List + threatening processes

★ Good vs bad worked answers

Study the contrast — the same question answered two ways. The strong column shows the moves that earn the marks.



The P·E·L answer structure — make a Point, support with Evidence, then Link to the question.

✗ WEAK ANSWER

There are lots of laws that protect animals. CITES is one and the EPBC Act is another. They both help stop animals going extinct by making rules about them. Names two instruments (1 mark) but never says what either does, never distinguishes their scales, and never shows how they "work together." No mechanism = no explanation marks.

✓ STRONG / MODEL ANSWER

CITES is an international treaty that regulates cross-border trade in endangered species, but a treaty has no legal force in Australia on its own. It is given effect domestically through the EPBC Act 1999 (Cth) , our national environmental law. The EPBC Act lists threatened species as Matters of National Environmental Significance and requires any action with a significant impact to be assessed and approved. So the international treaty sets the obligation and the national law enforces it — together they block both illegal export and habitat-destroying development. Scale + function for each (CITES = international/trade; EPBC = national/law), then the crucial "treaty enacted through national I